

Part One: Moon: your face is not an organ; impact

'We went to the moon to have fun, but the moon turned out to completely suck.'

1. How does this sentence set up the novel?
 2. What do you notice about the language Anderson uses? What is the composer's purpose?
 3. What is it like on the moon? Why is it a popular destination for young people?
 4. What do you know about the function of the 'feeds'? Consider 'going fugue' (p.7), 'the feed suggested "supple"' (p.11) advertisements at the end of chapters.1.
 5. What does Titus dislike about the moon?
 6. What does Titus hope to do on the moon? What does this indicate to the reader?
 7. Explain the term feeds.
4. Titus states that all the people are getting lesions. Why do you suppose he isn't alarmed by this?

Part One: the nose grid; the moon is in the house of boring

1. What does the girl that Titus is attracted to say about Quendy's lesion?
2. After the description the girl made of Quendy's face, how did Quendy's friends react?
3. What are the people that Titus' dad has labelled Eurotrash protesting?
4. At this point in the novel, what appears to be one purpose of the feed?
5. The police said, 'We're going to have to shut you off now.' What do they mean?
6. How does this chapter portray the way individuals live, interact and communicate?

Part Two: Eden: awake; college try; boring; still boring; missing the feed; cache & carry

1. What does Titus say is the best thing about the feed?
2. "The first thing I felt was no credit." Explain
3. Titus' reaction to a picture of a boat on a pond is one of confusion. Why does he find it so confusing?
4. 'He was a hacker and a naysayer of the worst kind.' What do you suppose is meant by naysayer?
5. Titus dismisses the message from the guy who hacked into his feed but laments the one that indicates he missed the sale at Weatherbee & Crotch. What impression of Titus does this help the reader create?

Part Two: Eden: father; salad days, w/sneeze guard; the garden; dead language; release

1. 'They want to subpoena your memories.' Explain.
2. Violet tells Titus that he's the only one who uses metaphor. What metaphor does he use that prompts this statement from Violet?
3. According to Violet, what is the definition of dead languages?
4. When asked, how does Violet respond to Titus' question, 'Why don't you use the feed?'
5. 'The salad days couldn't last forever.' Explain.

What does this chapter say about corporations?

- Choose a passage from Eden and describe its significance regarding consumerism.
- What are the main ideas/issues within the chapter Eden? How are they relevant today?
- Why is the chapter titled Eden?
- What do we learn about Titus and Violet?
- What questions are raised in Eden?

Analyse the following quote and **discuss the composer's purpose**.

"They're also waiting to make you want things. Everything we've grown up with...it's all streamlining our personalities so we're easier to sell to ... they do these demographic studies that divide everyone up into a few personality types, and then you get ads based on what you're sup-posedly like. They try to figure out who you are, and to make you conform to one of their types for easy marketing".

(p.80-81). Consider the impact on humanity.

Part Three: Utopia: normal; undervalued truffle; the others in mal, nudging

1. According to Titus, cool stuff starts with college age people and eventually becomes uncool. At what point does cool stuff eventually become not so cool anymore?
2. According to Titus, what kind of party do people have who are going through a midlife crisis?
3. On his feed, Titus picks up a broadcast from the President of the United States. What is the President speaking to the people about? What are the ramifications of this?
4. The night after the party Titus experiences something like a nudge on his feed, like someone is hacking into his feed. It feels like a dream. A voice tells him they're the police, but Titus believes they're a different group. Who does he think they are?

Part Three: Utopia: lose the chemise; a new place

1. Why do people now regard lesions as kind of cool?
2. Violet states that the feed is designed to streamline people's personalities so they're easier to sell to, and then the feed sends ads based on people's personality types. Eventually people become less varied. Violet wants to rebel against the feed. How successful is she in her rebellion against corporation?
3. According to Violet, how does the music industry get thirteen-year-olds screaming? What does this say about the society?
4. Titus is worried that Violet might be too smart for him, but then he states that it doesn't matter that she's smarter. How does the society support this idea?

Part Three: Utopia: the dimples of delglacey

1. According to Titus, why is school now run by corporations? What does this indicate about their world?
2. When chatting with Titus, Violet infers that feeds are used in a negative way. What is it about feeds that Violet believes is negative? Do you agree?
3. Violet claims to know what happened to the man in the club who hacked their feeds. What does this say about Violet?
4. Through Titus' feed, the news is broadcasted. We learn that the President's chat, not meant for the public, was intercepted. What problem has arisen through this intercepted chat?

Part Three: Utopia: lift; a question of moral; observe the remarkable verdure; a day in the country

1. Violet accompanies Titus and his father on a trip to test drive a new upcar. How is conflict created between Violet and Titus' father, and what is the purpose of this conflict?
2. What is it about Violet's father that strikes Titus as being very dated? How does this conflict with Titus' ideas of the society in which they live?
3. Violet's father speaks with a more traditional vocabulary; what does this foreshadow about Violet and her father?

Part Three: Utopia: a day in the country; nudging again; the real thing

1. After their day at the filet mignon farm, Titus drops Violet off at home and then flies to his house. His family is asleep and Titus listens to his feed. It tells him that lesions, now, are hip. Why are they hip? More importantly what does this indicate about how individuals are manipulated by the feed?
2. 'I could feel all of my family asleep... and all manner of things shall be well' (147-148). What effect does this long stream-of-consciousness narrative near the end of the chapter entitled 'a day in the country' evoke? What word would you use to describe Titus' state of mind?
3. Titus has a disturbing nightmare. Describe the images that Titus sees in his nightmare, and what they may foreshadow.
4. Through the feed, Violet wakes Titus from his nightmare. She, too, has received the images through the feed. What do you think has happened?

Part Three: Utopia: fight and flight; seashore; limbo and prayer; flat hope

1. On the first page of 'fight and flight', which sentence implies that poverty exists just outside Marty's gated community? What does this indicate about ethical behaviour?
2. When Violet tells Titus that her feed is malfunctioning, we learn that the feed isn't just responsible for communication. There are other implications for the human body as well. Discuss the control corporations have over individuals.
3. 'We flew over gray piles and gray piles and gray piles toward home' (172). What do you suppose are the gray piles?
4. What does Link do that creates shock and disgust in Titus, Violet and others who see what he does? How does this reflect the downfall of the society?

Part Three: Utopia: our duty to the party & Part Four/slumberland: 52.9%; 87.3%; 87.1%; 87.1%;

86.5%; 52.0%; 82.4%; 80.9%; 78.6%; 77.8%; 76.3%; 76.2%

1. Marty says that Quendy's lesions look sexy. Why does he think they are sexy? How does this convey the author's purpose?
2. Why are the chapter titles expressed as percentages? What do they represent and how do they make you feel? How does this dehumanize her?
3. Why have FeedTech and other corporate sponsors declined to repair Violet's feed? What does this indicate about ethical behaviour within this society?

Part Four: slumberland: 59.3%; 57.2%; 54.1%; 51.5%; summertime; the deep

1. Violet has lost her memory of when she was six years old to the time she was seven. What concerns her most about this memory loss?
2. As a defense against losing her memories and her past, what does Violet decide to do?
3. What does Titus do with the memories that Violet sends her? What does this indicate about Titus' humanity?

Part Four: slumberland: 4.6%

1. When Titus arrives at Violet's house, he sees her in bed with white discs attached to her body. Her head is shaved and reveals scars from operations that were made to try to save her. Her eyes are open but she is unresponsive. What does Titus believe she most resembles? How would you define Titus' state of mind at this moment?
2. After Titus has seen Violet's state, a confrontation occurs between himself and Violet's father. Violet's father is very distraught and Titus leaves in an agitated state. He returns home where he orders the same pair of pants over and through the feed until he has no credits left. Why does he engage in such irrational behaviour?
3. '... you're completely wrong about me thinking you're stupid. I always thought you could teach me things... You think you're stupid... But you're someone people could learn from' (276). Violet told Titus this the day after her last ride in his upcar. Later, in the last chapter when Titus returns to see Violet one last time, what does he say to Violet that might suggest Violet was right about Titus after all?